



Twitter support accs

Twitter will now help you to determine if contacting a brand via tweets will be of help. <http://dgit.in/TwtrSprtAcc>



SwiftKey goes neural

SwiftKey users now get the Neural Alpha machine learning for better text prediction. <http://dgit.in/SKNeurAlp>

TRICKS FOR YOUR CHROMEBOOK

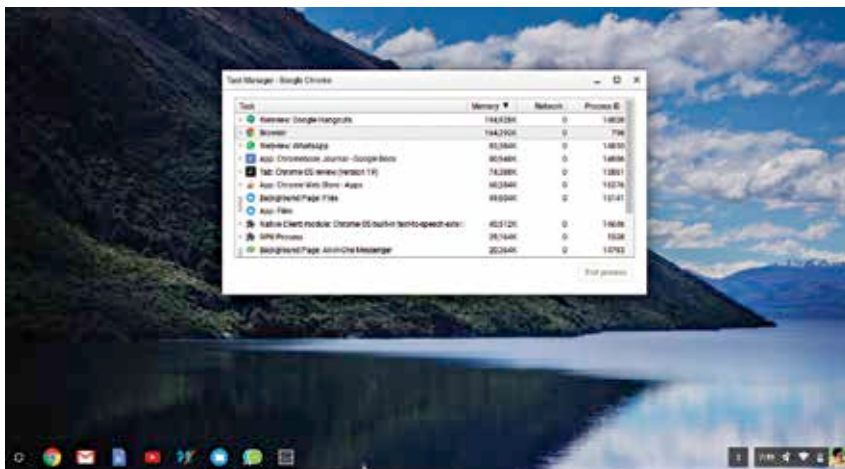
Anyone can use Google Chrome, and consequently, the Chrome OS. But to make the most out of it, here are some useful tips and tricks -

- **Use App launcher as Calculator and Converter** - Type your calculation or conversion into the search engine. The first response is usually the answer.
- **Ok Google** - Use the 'Ok Google' feature familiar from Android to similarly launch apps with your voice
- **The magic of three fingers** - a three finger tap on a link will open it in the background, and the same tap on a tab's header will close it.
- **Get Favicon bookmarks** - Right click on existing bookmark bar item and select 'edit', delete 'name' text and save
- **Search Gmail through omnibar** - Right click on omnibar, select 'Edit Search Engines', and in the fields at the bottom of the window, enter Name as Gmail, any keyword (e.g gms) and URL as <https://mail.google.com/mail/ca/u/0/#search/%s> and hit 'Done'. Typing that keyword followed by hitting tab in the omnibar will let you search on Gmail (The same method can let you search any other website as well with the correct URL)
- **Hard reset** - The Chromebook power button is a simple on/off switch, so how do you reset a frozen Chromebook? Use the shortcut <reload button>+<power button>
- **The most useful keyboard shortcut lists ever** - Ctrl+Alt+/ on a Chromebook.

ANDROID APPS ON CHROMEBOOK

Google has brought the Play Store to the dev and beta channels of Chrome OS version 53 (which is great), but only for some Chromebooks (which sucks). Switch to the developer channel by navigating to Settings > About and clicking on 'More info' under 'Check for and apply updates' button. You're almost there.

Scroll down to the 'Channel' section and hit 'Change channel'. Select 'Developer' and agree to the other prompts. Then update your Chromebook to get Play Store. Only supported for these models, though - <http://dgit.in/chrmespdroid>



Hit Search+esc to launch the task manager on Chrome OS

DAY
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Ending the process for 'Files' unmounts the shared network drives added via Network File Share app.

This is harder than I thought it would be.

Redemption

DAY
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Contrary to what I thought earlier, most of Google's apps do work offline, but only if Offline editing is explicitly enabled from account settings. This instantly makes the Chromebook insanely useful, considering the fact that these apps are actually lightweight and snappy. And more apps are headed its way everyday.

DAY
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The unique set of keys available on top of the laptop keyboard (which are a part of the Chromebook specification) are extremely useful. The Chrome OS supports a lot of keyboard shortcuts around those keys. Even without the shortcuts, the 'reload' and 'windows open' keys are a blessing while browsing online. Coupled with the trackpad gestures (three finger tab scrolling, two finger right click, and more) and all the keyboard shortcuts out of the box, I think this makes the Chrome OS design one of the most user friendly laptop OS designs out there, unless you're a stickler for Macs.

DAY
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Connecting my phone to the Chromebook once again demonstrated Google's sync between its apps. Once the OS detected the phone, it immediately offered to backup the media on the phone onto Google drive. Although this is not something that you cannot do on your own, who doesn't like a little easy prompting once in awhile?

DAY
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There is even a torrent client available, although it is not free. Let's hope the developers change that soon enough!

Conclusion

Honestly, I wasn't expecting the Chromebook to be much more than a 'use while you're travelling' device. In spite of the drawbacks, what I got out of the Chromebook was a pleasant surprise, both in terms of usage and the novelty of the idea. If anything, the Chrome OS is a strong indicator of the direction computing is headed - cloud-based applications, lightweight open-and-shut devices with perfect synchronisation. Just take a look at the Nextbit Robin if you doubt that statement. It may not be there yet, but it certainly does give an impression of being headed that way.